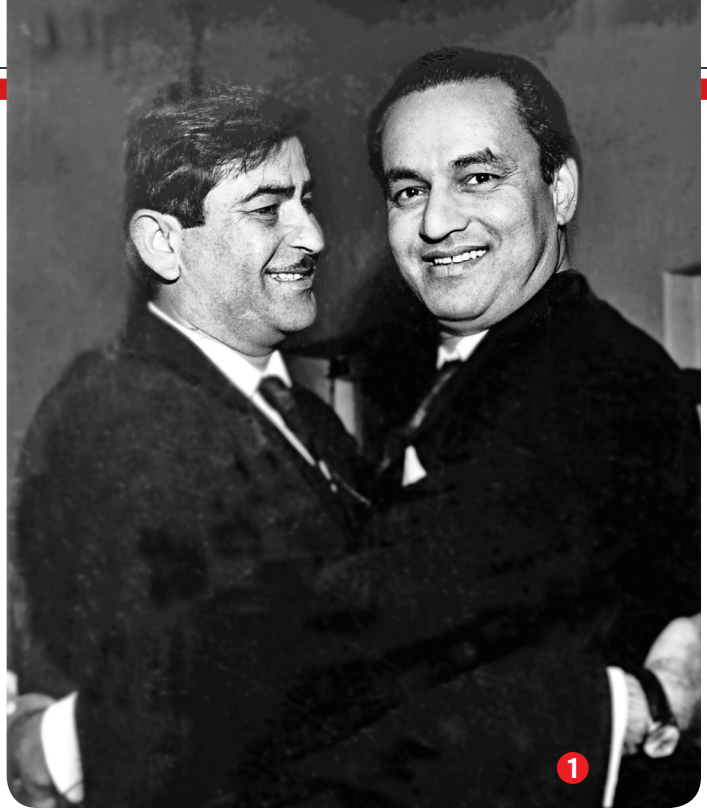
IN A GENIUS MOVE, PANCHAMDA GOT THE RECLUSIVE MANNA DEY TO SING THE SUPERCOOL '*AAO TWIST KAREIN*'



INDIAN EXPRESS

1. Raj Kapoor with Mukesh
2. Manna Dey

FAWZAN HUSAIN



morning to Annu Kapoor's Friday night *Antakshari*. What a decade it was. Then came the two most iconic songs of that decade—'***Tujhe dekha toh ye jaana sanam***' from *Dilwale Dulhania Le Jayenge* (*DDLJ*) and '***Pehla nasha***' from *Jo Jeeta Wohi Sikandar*. They defined the way millennials understood love. *DDLJ* had the best of the old and new school coming together for the music of the film. So Kumar Sanu paired up with the legendary Lata Mangeshkar, and Anand Bakshi penned the lyrics, collaborating with the young hit duo Jatin-Lalit. It was a match made in heaven. It's no wonder that Lata Bua, as I fondly knew her, called on her way from the recording to say this song was a sureshot hit.

But the real milestone came in 1992 when Mani Ratnam walked into the backyard of a relatively unknown jingle composer. He had heard his work in a Titan Watches ad. Ratnam was surprised at how sophisticated the studio was and how young the composer. After a brief talk, he asked the young man to compose the music for his upcoming film, *Roja*. That young man was A.R. Rahman. The result was the epic '***Bharat humko jaan se pyaara hai***' (both the Tamil and Hindi version), which became the '***Aye mere watan ke logon***' of this generation.

The 1980s, for me, are undefinable as they are a potpourri of firsts. '***Mile sur mera tumhara***', along with the iconic '*Hamara Bajaj*' ad jingle, united a nation. A new wave of pop music hit the Indian shores with the introduction of Nazia Hassan. And the genius Bappida gave us the epic sounds of 'Disco'. There was something for everyone. And then there was the introduction of Jagjit Singh into the mainstream musical heart of India with '***Woh kagaz ki kashti***'. He introduced an entire generation to the soothing genre of ghazals.

The 1960s and the '70s were the swinging years for Indian music. The Pancham (R.D. Burman) and Gulzar express was in full flow with superhit albums such as *Ghar*, *Aandhi* and *Parichay*. Panchamda paired up with Anand Bakshi, who was initially against writing the song (but later got convinced by the charming Dev Anand) and shocked the nation with his rebellious anthem, '***Dum maaro dum***'. Soon, Asha Bhosle began ruling the charts as the voice of a new generation. In another instance involving Panchamda's genius, he took the reclusive Manna Dey out of his comfort zone to sing the supercool '***Aao twist karein***'. Meanwhile, in Bengal, during a recording session, the legendary Salil Chowdhury pointed to a young sessions guitarist and said he would become one of India's best composers. That guitarist's name was Ilaiyaraaja.

A stroke of luck gave Kishoreda an opportunity to sing for superstar Rajesh Khanna in *Kati Patang* when (Mohammed) Rafi saab walked away from the project. We all know what happened after. Although Kishoreda won the Filmfare award for the song, '***Yeh jo mohabbat hai***', from the same film, '***Yeh shaam...***' has this magical aura around it that only gets better by the year.

S.D. Burman hit a home run with *Guide*, whose narrative-driven soundtrack gave us gems such as '***Din dhal jaaye***', '***Aaj phir jeene ki tamanna hai***' and '***Wahan kaun hai tera***'. Shailendra's pen performed the perfect coup de grâce with the evergreen '***Gaata***